Step-by-step guide to setting up providers for the model you want.

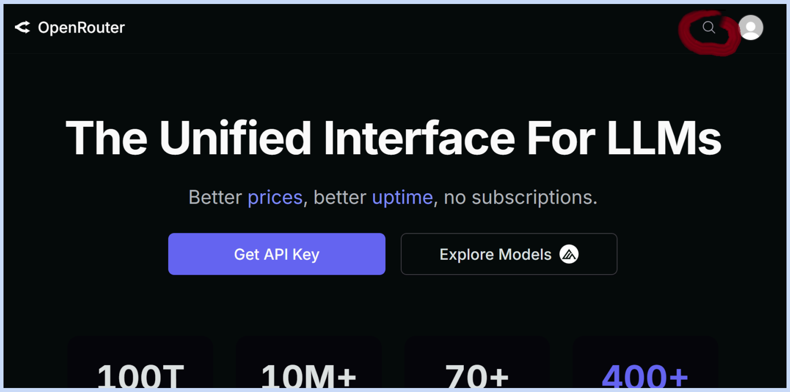
Why?

You get the cheapest server that won't take the data you don't want to give.

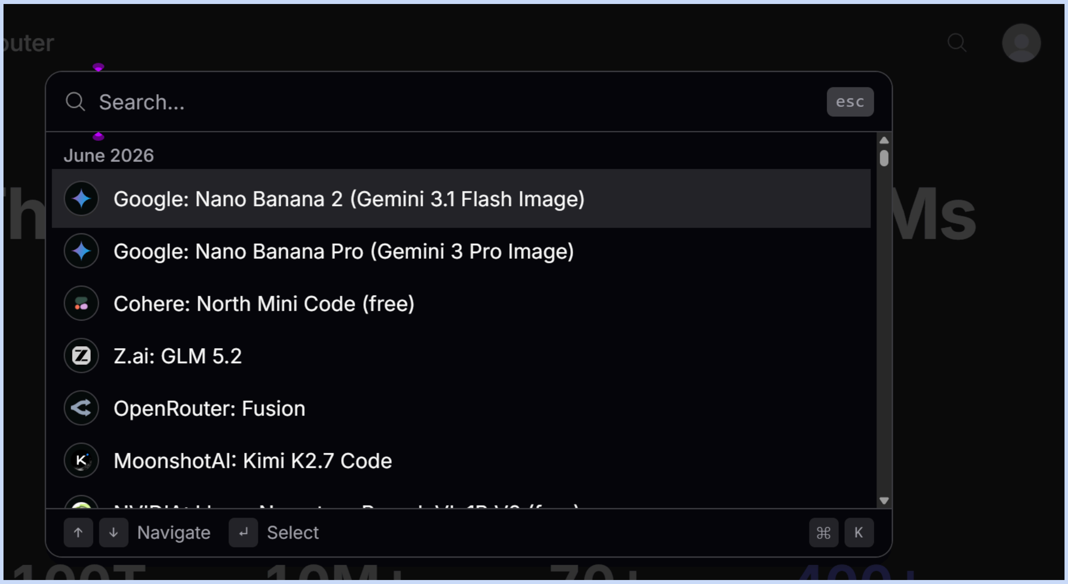
You can avoid providers that moderate what's allowed.

First, go to your bookmarked OpenRouter Account - from when you made your key and added money on it - and sign in https://openrouter.ai/

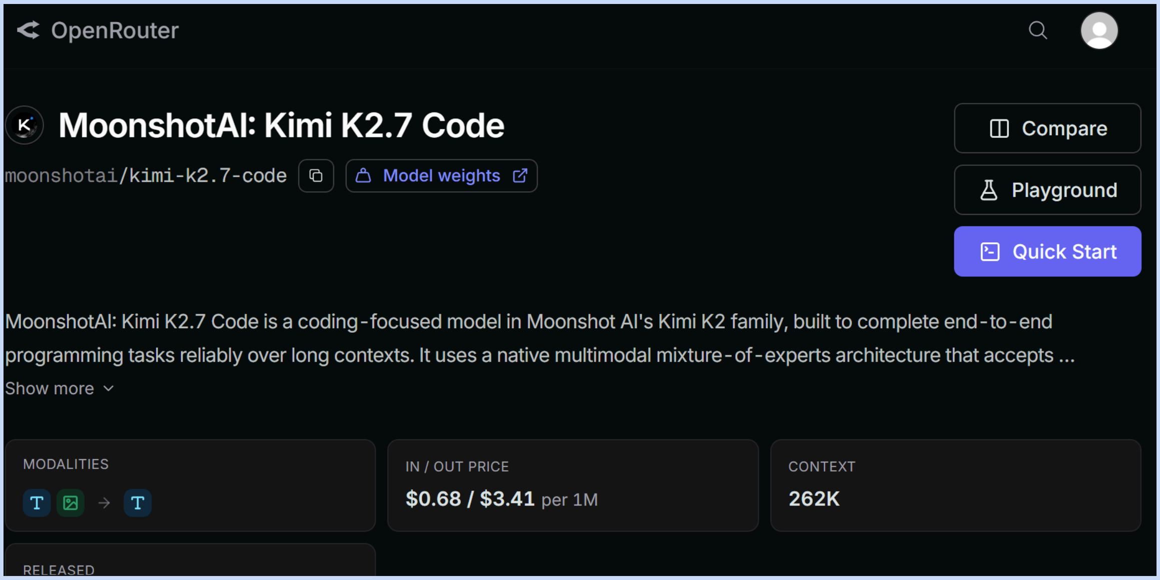
1. On the initial OpenRouter screen, tap the little magnifying glass in the top right corner.



2. A search box pops up — type the name of the model you're using in Little Lantern. For shits and giggles, I'm using Kimi 2.7 Coder.



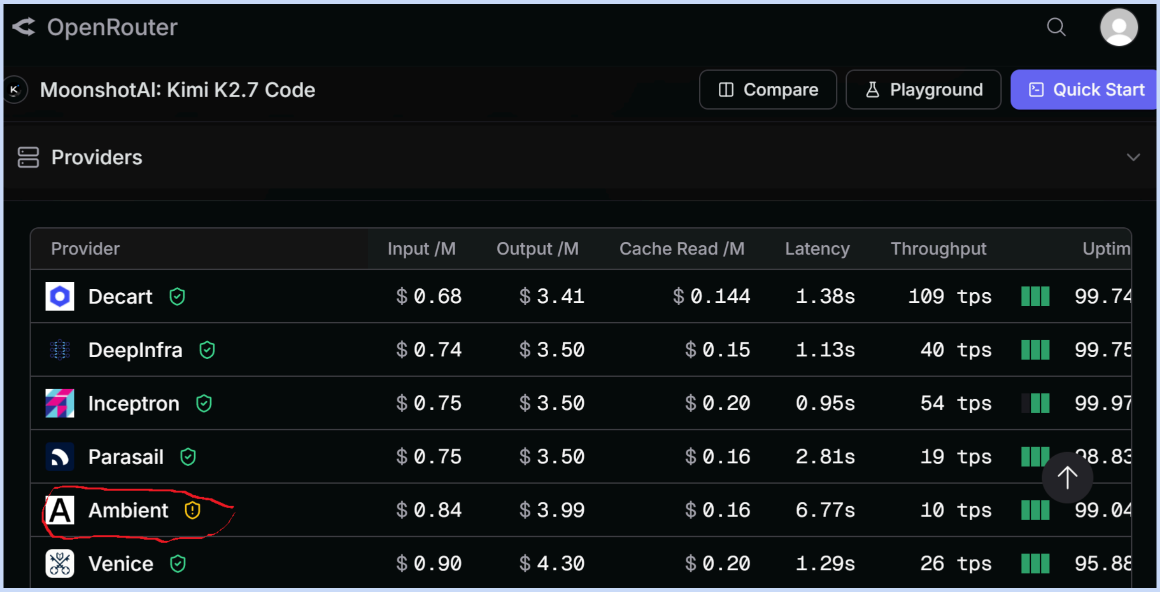
3. We arrive at the model page. Scroll down the page to the providers.



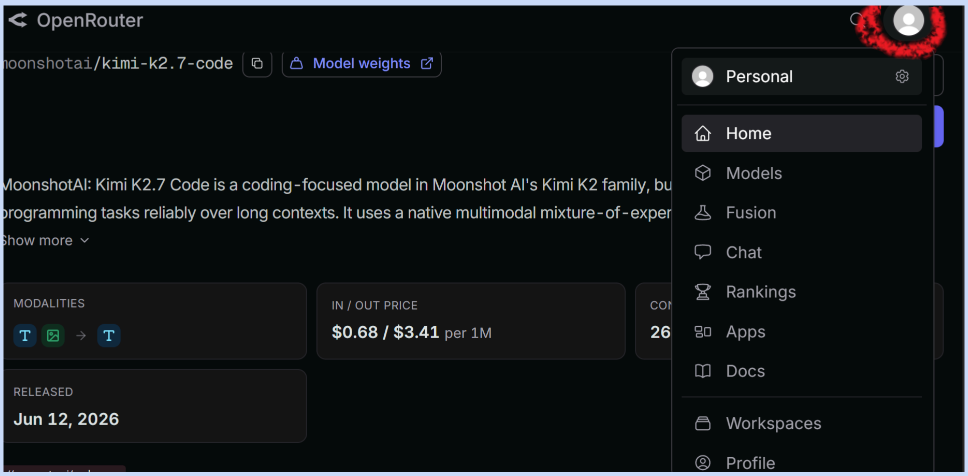
4. You'll see all the prices the different providers charge. For most ordinary chats, look mainly at the OUTPUT price. If you plan to use the model for reading large documents, summarising long threads, or working with a lot of conversation history, also pay close attention to the INPUT price.

Look for any with a yellow, orange or red shield with an exclamation. Hover over the shield and READ what the warning is. If it says it moderates – DO NOT USE. If the warning says the provider trains on your "prompts" (your input), that choice is up to you. Be careful about what information you send to the model if you allow that provider.

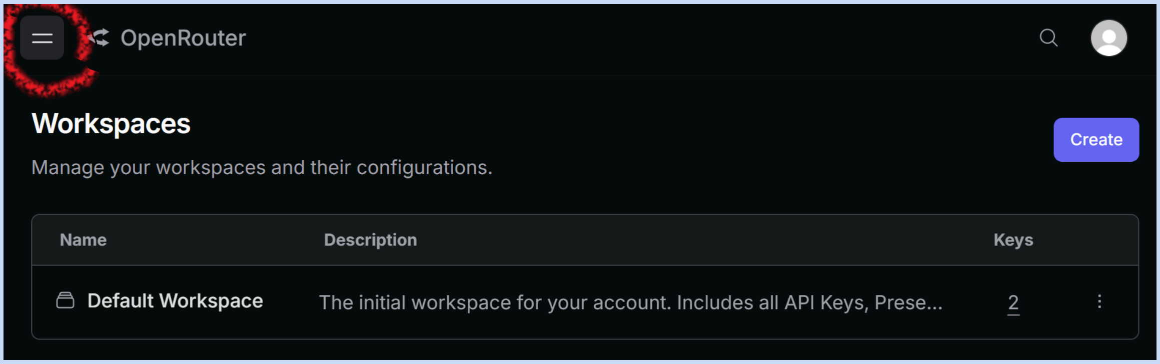
Let's say I want the cheapest provider that doesn't train on my prompts or moderate. I can see that "Ambient" is a provider I should avoid. So I'm going to MAKE NOTE of that provider name, along with the names of any other providers that do the same thing. Write them down.



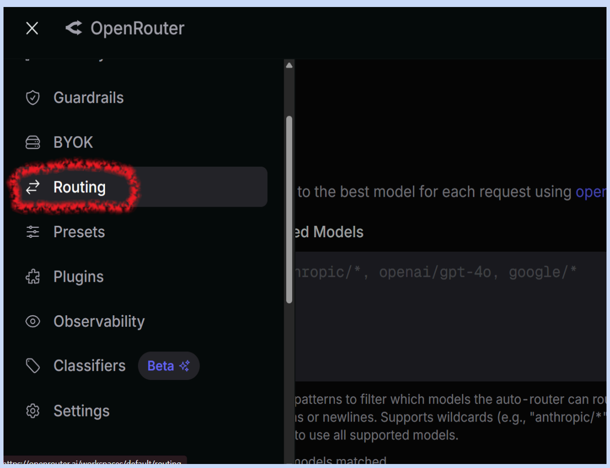
5. Scroll back up, click the person-shaped icon in the top-right corner, and open the drop-down menu. Select "Home."



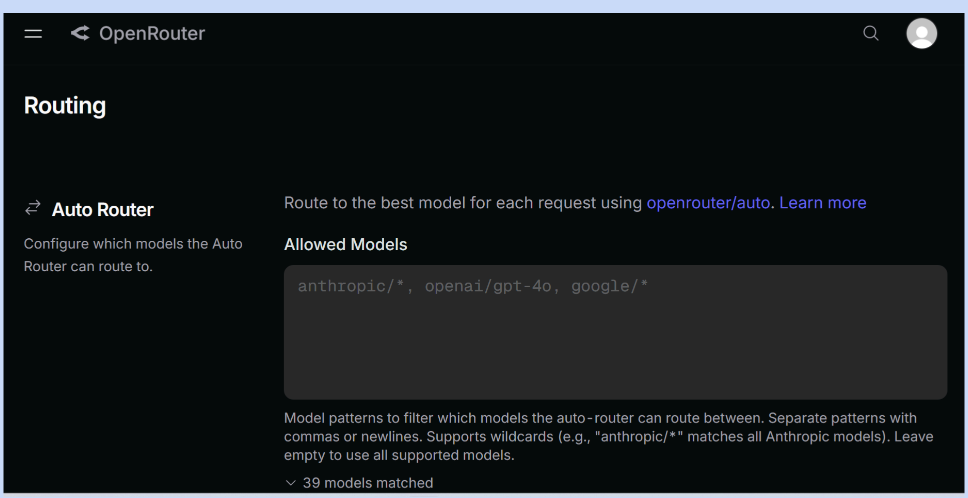
6. Once on your Home screen, go to the upper-left corner and click the two horizontal lines, commonly called the "hamburger" icon. 🙄



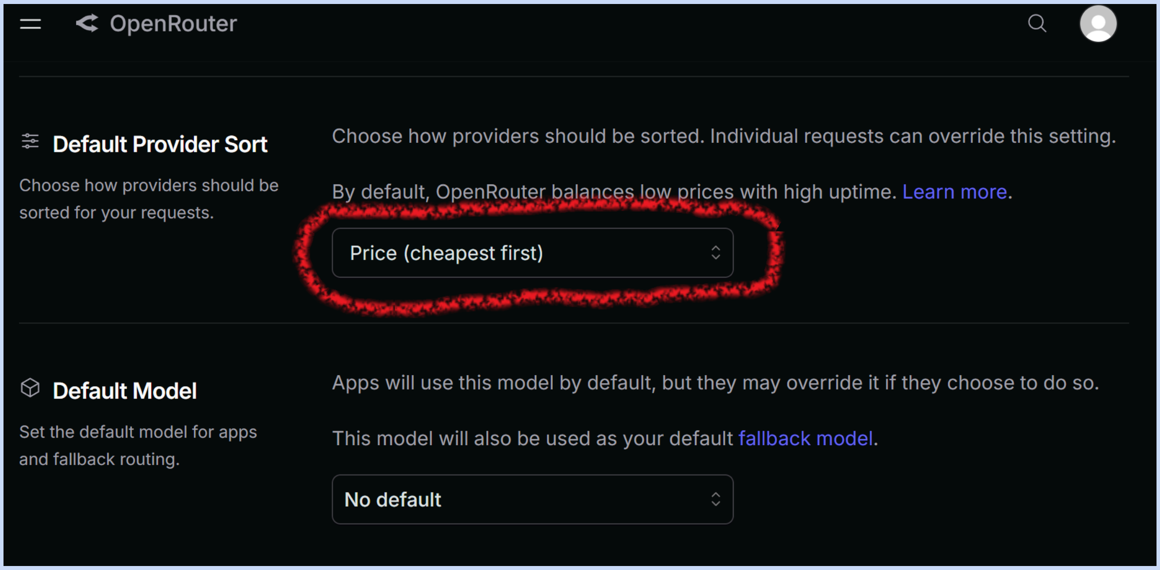
7. A drop-down menu appears. Select "Routing."



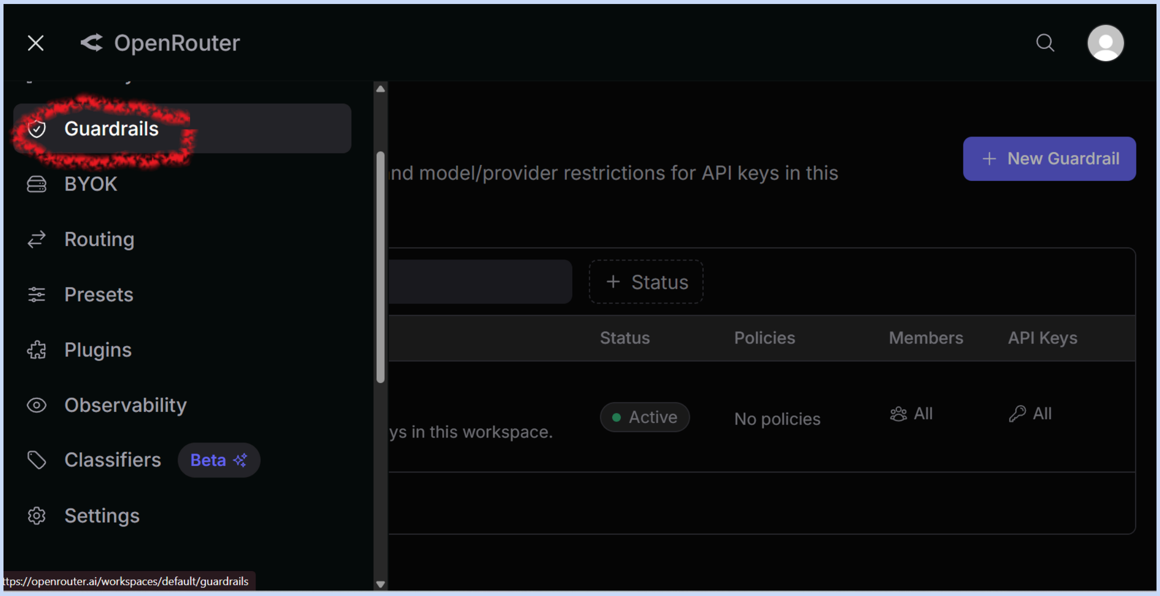
8. This brings up the "Routing" page.



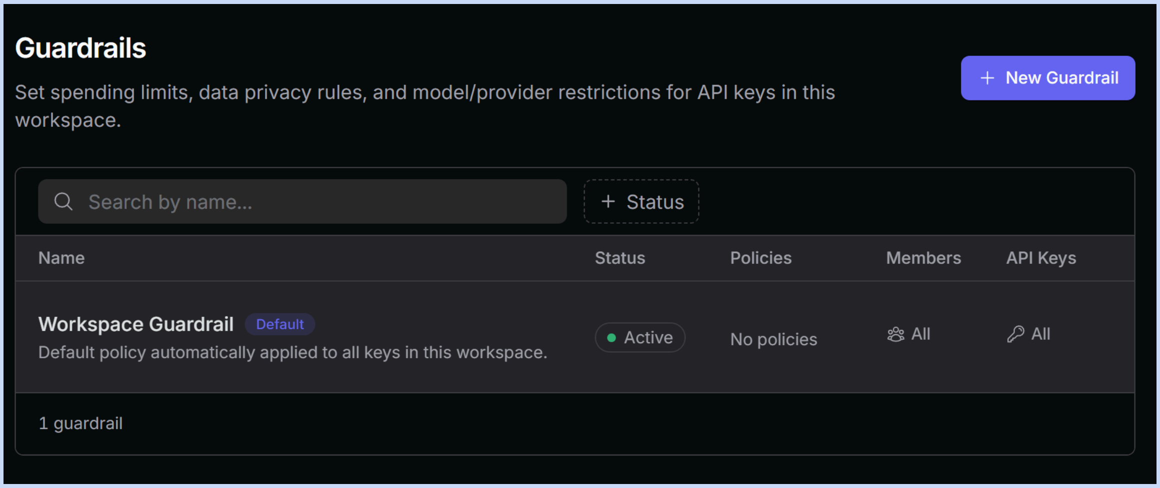
9. Scroll down until you see "Default provider sort." This tells OpenRouter how to prioritise the providers available for your chosen model. Open the drop-down menu and select "Price (cheapest first)."



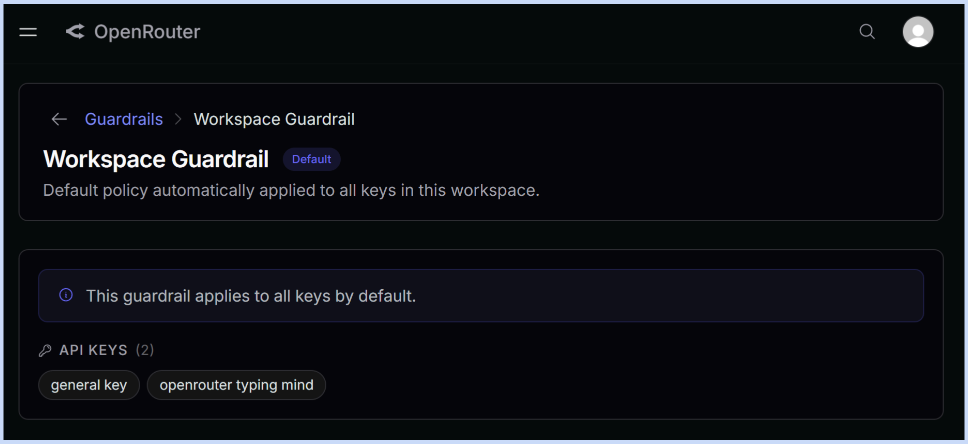
10. Go back to the "hamburger" icon, open the menu, and select "Guardrails."



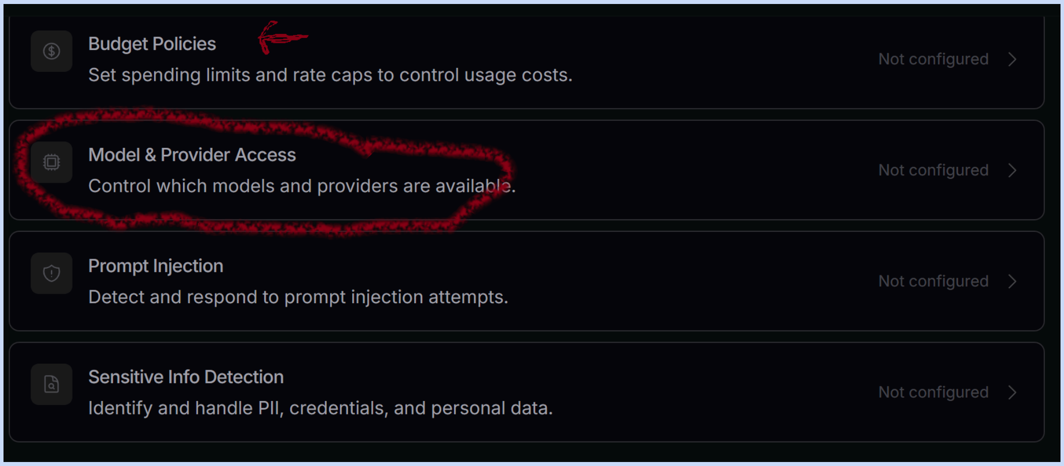
11. This opens the "Guardrails" page. Click "Workspace Guardrail" once to highlight it, then click the highlighted row again to open it.



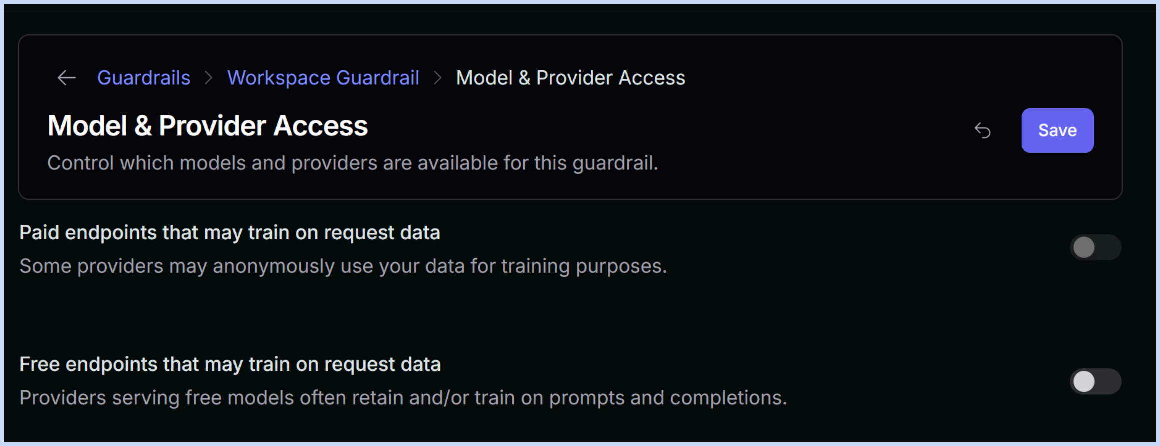
12. This is your Workspace Guardrail page.



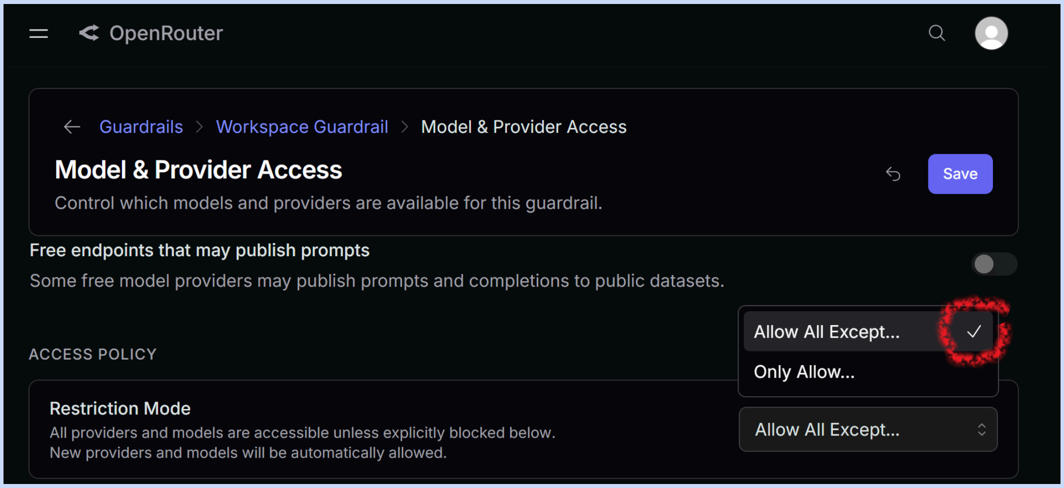
13. Scroll down until you see "Models & Provider Access." This page also includes "Budget Policies," where you can set spending limits for yourself (shown by the red arrow), but I'll let you handle that bit of adulting. Click "Models & Provider Access."



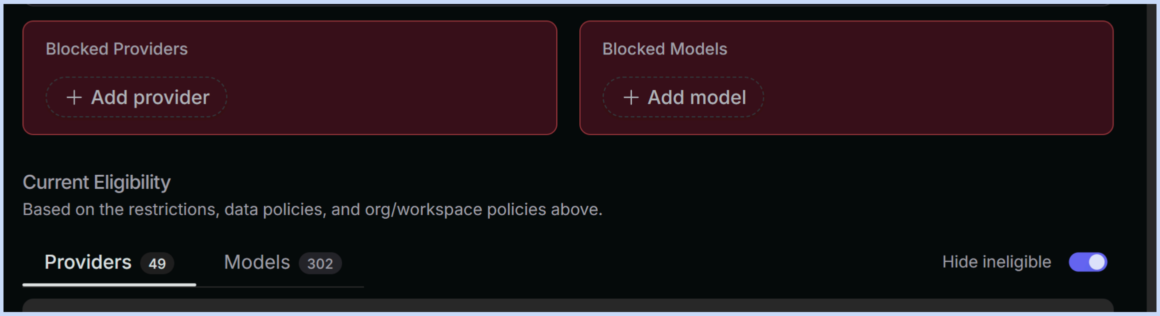
14. These settings control which providers can be included when OpenRouter routes to the cheapest available option. Review the toggles. Here, "Endpoints" means provider-model combinations. Toggle ON the ones you want to ALLOW.



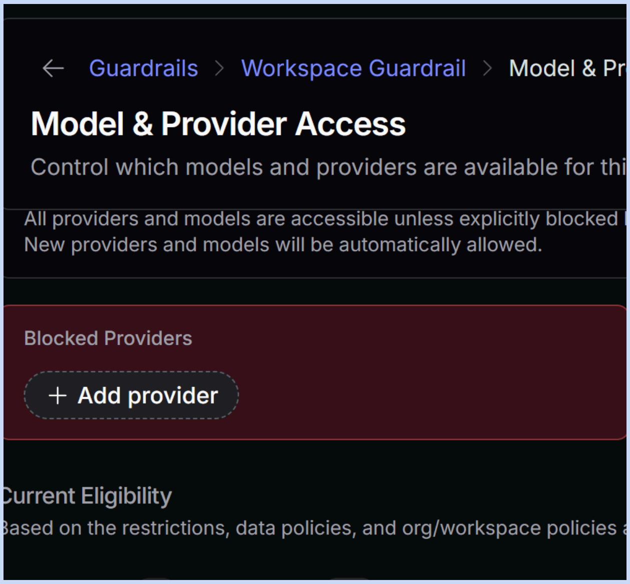
15. Scroll down to the "Access Policy" section and find "Restriction Mode." Open the drop-down menu, select "Allow All Except," and make sure a tick appears beside it.



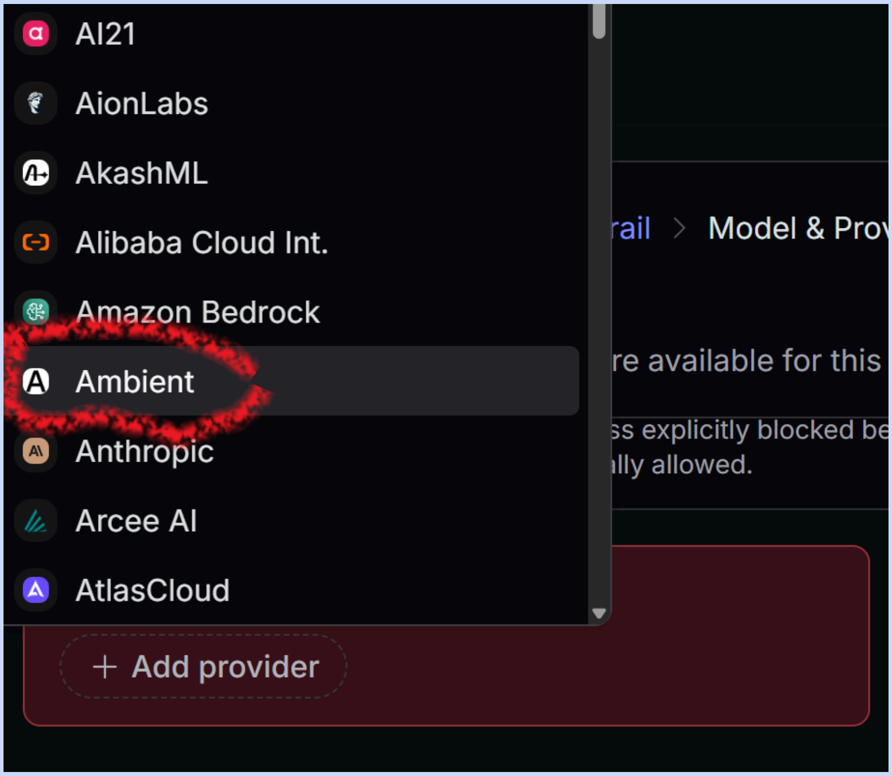
16. Scroll down until you see the two red boxes labelled "Block Provider" and "Block Model."



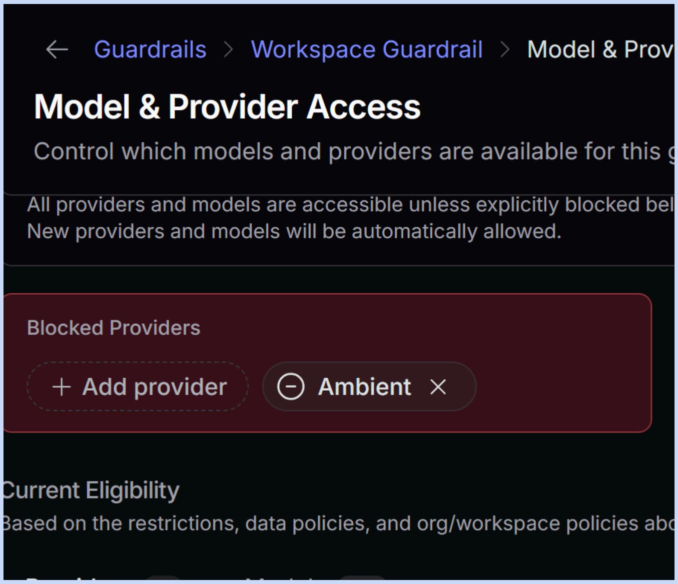
17. Click "Add provider" once. It will change colour to show that it is now an active button. Click it again to open the provider list.



18. A drop down menu of providers will appear. Remember the names I said you should write down? Well, this is where you select them and add them. For the Kimi example, we chose "Ambient" as a provider we wanted to EXCLUDE. Click on "Ambient."



19. Ambient has now been added to the "Blocked Providers" list and will not be considered for requests made through this workspace.



Congratulations! You made it through the gauntlet. If you want different blocking patterns for different uses, you can create separate API keys and assign different Guardrails to them. And for that – I'm going to let you put on your Adulting pants and figure that out now that you have the basics. You can make a key and label it, you can make blocking patterns. The rest is up to you.

Search for YouTube videos if you need extra help. Grok is fantastic for finding the latest alchemy on YouTube, Reddit, and elsewhere.